OrbiFlick: Release Plan for the App Store and Google Play

A practical, step-by-step plan for a solo creator on a small budget. Prepared 21 October 2026; updated 22 October 2026 for the rename to OrbiFlick.

> **How to read this.** Each section ends in concrete steps. Fees and store rules were checked against official sources on 21 October 2026 (links in Sources). Anything marked **(estimate)** is my rough guide, not a sourced fact. Anything marked ⚠ **check** is uncertain or changes often, so confirm it before you rely on it.

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0. At a glance

	Recommendation
Tech path	Wrap the existing HTML5 game with **Capacitor 8** (current stable 8.5.3). No rewrite.
Build iOS without a Mac?	Yes: **Codemagic** cloud builds (500 free Mac minutes a month for individuals). A Mac is still the easier path.
Native features to add	Preferences storage, Game Center + Play Games leaderboards, AdMob rewarded ads with Google UMP consent, RevenueCat for purchases, Firebase Analytics + Crashlytics, native haptics/share.
Fixed costs	Apple **US$99 per year**; Google **US$25 one-off**. Store commission **15%** on Apple (Small Business Program); Google's fees are **changing** (see §3).
Critical path	Google's **12 testers for 14 continuous days** rule for new personal accounts. Start the closed test in week 2.
Timeline	About **10 working weeks**: soft launch mid-December 2026, global launch **w/c 11 January 2027** (after the Christmas slowdown).
Game speed (current build)	Starts at **50%** of the original speed (0.725 rad/s). Every **150 points** adds **+10%** (+0.145 rad/s), eased in over 0.5 s with a "SPEED UP!" alert. Capped at **3.0 rad/s**, reached at about **2,400 points**.
Name	**OrbiFlick** chosen (22 Oct 2026). Initial screening is clear on both stores, the US trademark register, the main domains and the @handle. See §5.1.
⚠ **Biggest risk**	**Name clearance.** NETGEAR's live **ORBI** mark (class 9) and Habicus's ORBI (class 9) make OrbiFlick a **moderate trademark risk**. **Do now:** secure **orbiflick.com** and **@orbiflick**, and get a trademark lawyer to clear the name before you build the store records. See §5.1.

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1. Tech path: wrapping the HTML5 game

1.1 Options compared

Option	iOS	Android	Effort for OrbiFlick	Verdict
Capacitor (Ionic)	✅	✅	Low. The HTML file goes into `www/` almost unchanged.	**Recommended**
Cordova	✅	✅	Low, but the ecosystem is older and has fewer current plugins.	Workable, not preferred
TWA (Bubblewrap) / PWA	❌ (Play only)	✅	Very low, but no iOS store build and no native AdMob SDK.	Not suitable
Rewrite in Godot / Unity	✅	✅	High: a rebuild **(estimate: 3–6+ weeks for a solo beginner)**.	Not worth it at this stage

1.2 Why Capacitor

- **You keep your game.** It runs in the system WebView (WKWebView on iOS, Android System WebView), so your canvas, WebAudio and game logic stay as they are.
- **Plugins are maintained and current.** As of 21 Oct 2026 on npm: `@capacitor/core` 8.5.3, `@capacitor-community/admob` 8.2.1, `@revenuecat/purchases-capacitor` 13.7.4, `@capacitor-firebase/*` 8.5.2.
- **It handles Apple's "web wrapper" rule.** App Review Guideline 4.2 (Minimum Functionality) rejects apps that are just repackaged websites. OrbiFlick is a full offline game with native leaderboards, haptics and purchases, so it's well placed. Still, don't present it as "a website in an app".
- **Requirements:** Capacitor 8 needs Node.js 22+, Xcode 26+ and Android Studio Otter (2025.2.1)+. Apple has required apps to be built with **Xcode 26 / the iOS 26 SDK** since 28 Apr 2026. Google Play has required new apps and updates to **target Android 16 (API 36)** since 31 Aug 2026. Capacitor 8 defaults already meet both.

1.3 Steps (week 1)

1. Install Node 22 LTS, Android Studio and, if you have a Mac, Xcode 26.
2. Create the project (commands below), then copy `orbiflick.html` to `www/index.html`. Choose your **bundle ID** carefully: you cannot change it after you publish.

```
npm init -y
npm i @capacitor/core @capacitor/cli @capacitor/android @capacitor/ios
npx cap init "OrbiFlick" com.yourname.orbiflick --web-dir www
```

3. Run `npx cap add android` and `npx cap add ios`, then `npx cap sync`.
4. Run on a real phone. On Android, use `npx cap run android`. On iOS, open the project with `npx cap open ios` in Xcode, or use Codemagic (§3.3).
5. Use Git from day one, even a private GitHub repo. Tag every build you ship.

> **Tip:** Split the single file into `index.html`, `game.js` and `style.css` only if it helps you. It isn't required.

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2. Pre-launch game work

Work through these in order. Each item names the tool and the change to make.

2.1 Clean-up and security

☐ **Remove the debug hook.** Delete `window.ORBIFLICK = { G, startRun, … }` (line 838). Don't ship any other dev-only globals or console cheats either.

☐ Add a build flag (`const DEBUG = false`) so test tools can't leak into release builds.

☐ Strip `console.log` calls and minify for release (for example with `esbuild` or `terser`). This is optional, but it makes casual tampering harder.

2.2 Durable storage (replace localStorage)

Capacitor's own docs warn that WebView **localStorage "must be considered transient"**, because the OS may reclaim it when space is low.

☐ Swap the `get` / `set` helpers (lines 208–209) to use `@capacitor/preferences`, which uses native key-value storage. Keep the same `orbiflick_` keys. Preferences is async, so load everything once at boot into the in-memory `save` object.

☐ **One-off migration:** on first launch of the native build, copy any existing `orbiflick_*` localStorage values into Preferences.

☐ Save on important events (coin change, purchase, skin equip) and when the app is backgrounded (`@capacitor/app` → `appStateChange`).

Cloud save options, from simplest to most work:

Option	What it covers	Effort	When
Store-restored purchases (RevenueCat / StoreKit / Play Billing)	Anything **paid** (ad removal, premium skins) comes back on reinstall or a new device.	Comes with IAP	**Launch: required**
Firebase Anonymous Auth + Firestore	Coins, unlocked skins, streak, best score	Medium	v1.1 (post-launch)
Game Center saved games / Play Games Saved Games	Same, using platform accounts	Medium–high, with thinner Capacitor support	Only if you want to avoid Firebase

> **Recommendation:** launch with Preferences plus store-restored purchases. Add a Firebase cloud save in v1.1 if players ask for it. Paid items are what really must survive a reinstall, and the stores already handle that.

2.3 Real global leaderboards

Option	Pros	Cons
Game Center (iOS) + Google Play Games Services (Android)	Free, no server, players already signed in, built-in daily/weekly views. Game Center now also shows in Apple's Games app.	Two separate leaderboards (one per platform). The Capacitor plugin is small.

Option	Pros	Cons
Firebase (Firestore + Cloud Functions)	One cross-platform board, fully custom	You must build anti-cheat and moderation. Cloud Functions need the pay-as-you-go plan (⚠ **check current Firebase pricing**).

☐ **Recommended:** platform leaderboards via `@openforge/capacitor-game-connect` (v5.0.2, updated Sept 2026; about 900 npm downloads a month). It's a small plugin, so **prototype it in week 4 and keep the local top-10 as a fallback**.

☐ Create two boards on each platform: **All-time best** and **Daily Challenge**. Use a recurring leaderboard on Game Center and a daily time span on Play Games. This fits your date-seeded daily mode neatly.

☐ Set a plausible maximum score in each console to reject obviously hacked scores.

☐ Keep the local top-10 for offline play and for players who decline sign-in.

2.4 Rewarded ads (second chance)

☐ Install `@capacitor-community/admob` (8.2.x). It wraps the Google Mobile Ads SDK and includes **Google UMP consent** and **iOS App Tracking Transparency** helpers.

☐ Replace the placeholder second chance with a rewarded ad. Give the reward **only on the "rewarded" event**, never on "dismissed".

☐ Keep it opt-in: one second chance per run, with a clear "No thanks". AdMob policy requires that users **affirmatively opt in** to each rewarded ad.

☐ **Use Google's test ad unit IDs during all development.** Clicking your own live ads can get your AdMob account suspended.

☐ Preload the next rewarded ad after each run so the button never waits on a network call. Hide the button when offline or when no ad is loaded.

☐ Publish an `app-ads.txt` file on your developer website (the URL listed in the stores). AdMob uses it to verify your inventory.

☐ Startup order: request UMP consent → (iOS) ATT prompt if you want tracking → initialise AdMob → preload the rewarded ad.

2.5 In-app purchases

☐ Use **RevenueCat** (`@revenuecat/purchases-capacitor`). One API covers StoreKit and Google Play Billing, handles receipts and restores purchases. It's **free until US$2,500 monthly tracked revenue**, then 1% of the total.

☐ Suggested launch catalogue. Prices are **estimates**, so test them.

Product	Type	Suggested price	Notes
OrbiFlick Plus (no ads + free revive)	Non-consumable	£2.99–£3.99	See decision 2: with rewarded-only ads, plain "remove ads" removes very little.
Neon Pack (3 premium skins)	Non-consumable	£1.99	Cosmetic only
Legend skin (e.g. animated)	Non-consumable	£0.99–£1.99	Cosmetic only
Coin bag (optional)	Consumable	£0.99	Coins buy cosmetics only, so this is **not pay-to-win**

☐ Add a **Restore Purchases** button in Settings or the Shop. Apple expects one for non-consumables.

☐ **Avoid paid random rewards (loot boxes)** entirely. If you ever add them, both stores require you to show the odds before purchase. Belgium is commonly reported to treat paid loot boxes as gambling **(⚠ check)**.

☐ Test purchases with Apple **Sandbox / TestFlight** accounts and Google Play **licence testers**.

2.6 Performance on low-end devices

☐ Test on a cheap Android phone (2–4 GB RAM) and the oldest iPhone you can borrow.

☐ Add a **"Low effects"** toggle that cuts particles and trail length, and switch it on automatically if the frame time stays above ~20 ms (under ~50 fps).

☐ You already cap the device pixel ratio at 2. Consider 1.5 on low-end Android.

☐ Pause the game loop and suspend the `AudioContext` when the app is backgrounded. Resume on return, because iOS needs audio resumed after an interruption.

☐ Pre-render static rings and glow to an offscreen canvas instead of redrawing blur every frame.

2.7 App shell: icon, splash, orientation, safe areas

☐ **Icon:** 1024×1024 PNG master with no transparency on iOS. Generate every size with `@capacitor/assets`. Google Play also needs a 512×512 icon and a 1024×500 feature graphic.

☐ **Splash:** `@capacitor/splash-screen`. Use a dark background in your neon palette and hide it as soon as the canvas has drawn.

☐ **Orientation:** lock to portrait. Set it in Xcode (Deployment Info) and with `android:screenOrientation="portrait"` in `AndroidManifest.xml`, or use `@capacitor/screen-orientation`.

☐ **Safe areas:** you already have `viewport-fit=cover`. Pad the HUD with `env(safe-area-inset-top)` etc. so it clears the notch and Dynamic Island. Use `@capacitor/status-bar` to hide or style the status bar.

☐ **Android back button:** with `@capacitor/app` → `backButton`, go from game to pause, pause to menu, and menu to exit.

2.8 Audio and haptics

☐ **Haptics:** `navigator.vibrate` doesn't work on iOS. Switch to `@capacitor/haptics` (impact light/medium for taps, near-misses and death) and keep the existing call as the web fallback.

☐ Add separate **Sound** and **Haptics** toggles, and save them.

☐ Test with the iPhone silent switch on, with Bluetooth headphones, and with an incoming call during a run.

2.9 Share

☐ Replace `navigator.share` with `@capacitor/share`. Share a **score card image** drawn from the canvas plus your store link (see §7.1).

2.10 Offline play

☐ The game is self-contained, so bundle everything locally and load nothing from a CDN.

☐ Degrade gracefully when offline: hide the ad button, queue leaderboard submissions and keep the daily challenge working (it's date-seeded). Use the **UTC date** consistently so the daily challenge is the same for everyone.

2.11 Analytics and crash reporting

☐ **Firebase Analytics + Crashlytics** via `@capacitor-firebase/analytics` and `@capacitor-firebase/crashlytics` (8.5.2). Crashlytics reports native crashes. Also send JS errors with `recordException` from a `window.onerror` handler.

☐ Log a small, fixed set of events:

Event	Key params	Answers
`run_start` / `run_end`	mode, score, duration_s, cause	Session length and difficulty curve
`first_run_complete`	score	Onboarding drop-off
`revive_offered` / `revive_accepted`	score	Rewarded ad opt-in rate
`ad_reward_granted`	placement	Ad revenue driver
`iap_purchase`	product_id	Monetisation
`skin_equip`, `skin_buy`	skin_id	Cosmetic appeal
`daily_play`, `streak_claim`	day	Live-ops health
`share`	context	Viral loop

☐ Tie analytics and ad personalisation to the consent result (§4). Don't log personal data.

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3. Store accounts and costs (verified 21 Oct 2026)

3.1 Fees and commission

Item	Cost	Source
Apple Developer Program	**US$99 per membership year**, shown in local currency at enrolment	Apple: enrol
Google Play Console	**US$25 one-off** registration fee. Prepaid cards not accepted; may ask for government ID.	Play Console Help
Apple commission	30% standard; **15%** in the App Store Small Business Program (new developers, or under US$1M proceeds a year). **You must enrol.**	Apple Small Business Program
Google Play fee: rest of world	**15%** on the first US$1M of yearly earnings if you enrol in the 15% tier	Google service fees
Google Play fee: US, UK, EEA (from 30 Jun 2026); Australia, Japan (from 30 Sep 2026)	**New structure ⚠:** service fee plus a separate **5% billing fee** when you use Play Billing. Google's blog says the service fee "starts at 10%" on the first US$1M; the Help Centre table lists 20% (new installs) for other transactions, or 15% in the Play Games Level Up programme. The details are confusing, so **check your Play Console** before setting prices.	Google service fees, Google blog, 24 Jun 2026
RevenueCat	Free under US$2,500 monthly tracked revenue, then 1% of the total	RevenueCat billing docs
Codemagic (cloud Mac builds)	500 free Mac mini M2 minutes a month (individual), then US$0.095/min	Codemagic pricing

Account steps

1. **Apple:** enrol as an **Individual**. Your legal name appears as the seller. Enrolling as an Organisation needs a legal entity and a D-U-N-S number. You need two-factor authentication on your Apple Account. Once

approved, sign the **Paid Applications Agreement** in App Store Connect, add bank and tax details, and **enrol in the Small Business Program**.

2. **Google:** create a **personal** developer account with a dedicated Google account and complete identity verification. Then set up a payments profile, **enrol in the 15% tier / account group** where it applies, and link **AdMob** and **Firebase**.
3. **AdMob:** create the account, add both apps (they can be linked to the store listings later), and create one rewarded ad unit per platform.

3.2 Google Play's testing rule for new personal accounts

Personal developer accounts created after 13 Nov 2023 must run a **closed test with at least 12 testers who stay opted in for at least 14 continuous days** before applying for production access. **Internal testing doesn't count.** When you apply, you answer questions about your test. Google may ask for more testing if engagement looks low. (Play Console Help)

- **Plan:** recruit **15–20 testers** to allow for drop-outs: friends, family, Discord, r/AndroidClosedTesting, local game-dev groups. Testers need a Google account and an Android phone.
- Start the closed test **as early as possible (week 2)** with a basic build, then keep pushing updates to the same track. The 14-day clock runs while you keep building.
- Don't buy fake testers. Google looks at engagement and wants real feedback.
- Organisation accounts are exempt, but they need a legal entity and a D-U-N-S number. That isn't worth setting up just for this.

3.3 Building iOS without a Mac

Route	Cost	Notes
Your own Mac (any Apple-silicon Mac that runs Xcode 26)	Hardware **(estimate: £400+ used)**	Easiest for debugging on a real iPhone
Codemagic	Free tier (500 min a month)	Has an official Capacitor sample. It can sign builds and upload them to TestFlight. A typical build is roughly 10–20 min **(estimate)**.
Rented cloud Mac (e.g. MacinCloud)	Monthly fee **(⚠ check)**	A fallback if you need the Xcode interface
Xcode Cloud	Some free hours come with the Apple membership **(⚠ check)**	Needs Xcode on a Mac for setup

> **Without a Mac you can't easily debug iOS-only issues.** Borrow a Mac for a day if you hit one. Test on a real iPhone via TestFlight.

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4. Legal and compliance

> I'm not a lawyer and this isn't legal advice. It covers the usual steps a solo developer takes. If you aim at children or earn significant revenue, get professional advice.

4.1 Privacy policy (both stores require one)

☐ Host it at a stable URL, for example `orbiflick.com/privacy` (or `yourname.dev/orbiflick/privacy`) (GitHub Pages is free). Use the same site for `app-ads.txt` and a support email.

☐ Cover: who you are and how to contact you; the data collected by **AdMob, Firebase, RevenueCat, Game Center and Play Games**; what each is used for; legal basis (UK GDPR / EU GDPR: consent for ads, legitimate interests for crash reporting); retention; user rights; children; how to withdraw consent (add a **"Privacy settings"** button that reopens the UMP form).

☐ Generators such as App Privacy Policy Generator or Termly can give you a starting draft **(⚠ check terms)**. Then edit it to match your SDKs.

4.2 Apple App Privacy labels and Google Data safety

☐ Fill in **App Privacy** in App Store Connect and the **Data safety** form in Play Console. Google publishes AdMob disclosure guides for both (iOS, Android). Firebase and RevenueCat have similar pages.

☐ Typical answers for this setup: device or advertising identifiers, product interaction, diagnostics (crashes), purchase history, and coarse location as used by ads **(⚠ check against each SDK's current guide)**.

☐ **Privacy manifests (iOS):** current AdMob, Firebase and RevenueCat SDKs ship their own. Keep the SDKs up to date and check Xcode's privacy report before you submit.

☐ If you add accounts (e.g. Firebase cloud save with sign-in), Google requires a way to **delete the account** in the app and on the web. Anonymous cloud save avoids most of this.

4.3 ATT and GDPR consent

☐ **EEA, UK and Switzerland:** Google requires a **Google-certified CMP** (IAB TCF) to serve personalised ads. Without one, only limited ads are served. **Google UMP** is free, certified and built into the AdMob plugin (AdMob Help).

☐ **iOS ATT:** you must show the system prompt before using the IDFA for tracking. Add `NSUserTrackingUsageDescription` (e.g. "Allow tracking to show ads that are more relevant to you. OrbiFlick stays free either way."). UMP can show an explainer screen first. Simpler option: **don't request ATT** and serve non-tracking ads. You'll earn less per ad, but the app is simpler and more privacy-friendly. **(estimate: the size of the revenue drop varies)**

☐ Show consent once, at first launch before the first ad, and never in the middle of a run.

4.4 Age ratings

☐ **Apple:** answer the updated age-rating questionnaire in App Store Connect. Apple's ratings are now 4+, 9+, 13+, 16+ and 18+, and answers were compulsory from 31 Jan 2026 (Apple). OrbiFlick has no violence or user-generated content, so it will probably get a low rating. Mention ads and IAP honestly.

☐ **Google:** complete the **IARC** content-rating questionnaire in Play Console. It issues ratings such as PEGI (UK/EU), ESRB and USK automatically. Expect PEGI 3 **(estimate)**.

4.5 Children and families

A bright, simple one-tap game **will attract children** even if you don't target them.

☐ **Google Play target audience:** you must declare age groups. Including under-13s brings in the **Families Policy**: only Families self-certified ad SDKs, no personalised ads for children, and a neutral age screen for mixed audiences (Families policy). **Simplest compliant route: target 13+** and make sure your listing and art don't specifically appeal to young children **(⚠ Google judges this from your store presence)**.

☐ **UK ICO Children's Code** (Age Appropriate Design Code) applies to services **likely to be accessed** by children, games included. Practical steps: privacy-friendly defaults, minimal data, no nudging, clear wording

(ICO).

☐ **Apple Kids category:** don't opt in. It brings strict rules on third-party ads and analytics.

☐ Keep monetisation child-safe anyway: no fake timers, no "only 2 left!" pressure, prices shown clearly, and no in-run purchase prompts.

4.6 Loot boxes and IAP disclosure

☐ The current design (fixed-price cosmetics, coins earned or bought) has **no loot boxes**. Keep it that way.

☐ Both stores list "In-app purchases" and "Contains ads" on your page automatically once you declare them. Make sure those declarations are accurate.

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5. Store listing and ASO

5.1 Name: OrbiFlick (chosen 22 Oct 2026)

The game was renamed **OrbiFlick** (brand spelling; the in-game logo is stylised **ORBIFLICK**). The previous working title clashed with a live same-genre game on the App Store, and its suffix carried trademark risk.

> ⚠ **Immediate to-do (this week, before anything else is public):**
>
> ☐ Register **orbiflick.com** (add **orbiflick.app** and **orbiflick.games** too if you can; they're cheap).
>
> ☐ Claim **@orbiflick** on TikTok, Instagram, YouTube and X/Bluesky, even if you won't post yet.
>
> ☐ Book a **trademark lawyer** to clear the name before you create the store records and icon.

Screening results (22 October 2026; a quick screen, not a legal clearance):

Check	Result
App Store / Google Play	**No app titled OrbiFlick** found
US trademark register (USPTO)	**No ORBIFLICK** mark found
Domains	**orbiflick.com**, **.app** and **.games** looked **unregistered**
Social handle	**@orbiflick** looked **unregistered**
Similar app names	**"OrbFlick: Tick Tally"** on APKPure (a nearby name; check what it is and whether it's active); a **"Mystic Orb Flick"** listing that has since been removed
Nearby trademarks	⚠ **ORBI (NETGEAR)**, live in **class 9** (software / electronics), and **ORBI (Habicus)**, also class 9. Games are class 9 (downloadable) and 41 (online services). **Moderate risk:** OrbiFlick only shares the ORBI prefix, but NETGEAR is a large brand owner.
Not checked	**UK IPO and EUIPO** registers; **.io** and **.gg** domains

- **Verdict:** a good candidate with no direct conflicts. The ORBI marks are the open question. Get **professional clearance** (US, UK and EU, classes 9 and 41) before you spend on art and marketing, and register the domains and handles **now**, since they cost little and can disappear.
- Consider filing your own **OrbiFlick** trademark (UK IPO and/or USPTO, classes 9 and 41) once the lawyer is happy **(estimate: from ~£170 for one UK class; check current fees)**.
- Use a descriptive store title for search, e.g. **"OrbiFlick: One-Tap Orbit"** (see §5.2).

5.2 Listing fields

Field	Limit	Draft
App name (Apple) / Title (Google)	30 chars	*OrbiFlick: One-Tap Orbit* (24 chars)
Subtitle (Apple)	30 chars	*One tap. One chance.*
Short description (Google)	80 chars	*Tap to switch orbits, dodge spikes, grab coins. How far can one tap take you?*
Keywords (Apple, hidden)	100 chars, comma-separated	`one tap,arcade,reflex,orbit,circle,dodge,neon,casual,offline,daily challenge,skins,hyper`
Promotional text (Apple)	170 chars, editable without review	Use it for events: *"Halloween Ghost skin this week only!"*

Keyword tips: don't repeat words that are already in the name or subtitle. Don't use competitor names. In week 5, check search volume with a free ASO tool or plain App Store autocomplete **(estimate: paid tools aren't needed at launch)**.

5.3 Description draft (Google full description: 4,000 chars)

> **One tap. One chance.**
> Your ball races around two glowing orbits. Tap to jump between the inner and outer ring, slip past red spikes and snatch coins. Sounds simple, until the speed starts climbing.
>
> **Why you'll keep playing**
> • Instant one-tap controls: easy to learn, brutal to master
> • Build combos up to x9 and score near-miss bonuses for daring dodges
> • A new Daily Challenge every day: same course for everyone, so you can compare scores
> • Daily rewards with a streak bonus
> • Unlock 8+ neon skins with unique trails: fire, sparkle, ghost and rainbow
> • Global leaderboards via Game Center / Google Play Games
> • Plays offline, with no account needed
> • Optional ads only: watch one to keep a run going, or skip it. Never pay-to-win.
>
> Can you beat your best?

5.4 Screenshots and video

Asset	Apple	Google
Phone screenshots	Required: **1320×2868** (6.9") portrait; up to 10. Smaller sizes scale down. (spec)	2–8 phone screenshots; **1080×1920** recommended **(⚠ check current spec in Console)**
Video	App preview, **15–30 s**, 886×1920 portrait (spec)	YouTube link (shown above screenshots)
Other	—	Feature graphic 1024×500, icon 512×512

Your current screenshots are 780×1688, which isn't a store size. Capture new ones from the iOS Simulator (iPhone 17 Pro Max class) or render them at 1320×2868.

Screenshot set (6):

1. Gameplay with a big headline: "ONE TAP. ONE CHANCE."
2. Near-miss moment with a combo popup: "Dodge by a pixel. Combo x9."
3. Skins grid: "Unlock neon skins & trails."
4. Daily Challenge: "New challenge every day."
5. Leaderboard: "Beat the world."
6. "Play offline. No pay-to-win."

Video (20–25 s): a 1-second hook (fast near-miss), then the speed ramp, a combo build and a skin swap, then a game-over with a big score and "Can you beat it?". Record real gameplay with no fake footage; Apple requires captured footage.

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6. Testing

6.1 Test stages

Stage	Tool	Who	When
Internal	**Play internal testing** (up to 100 testers, builds within seconds); **TestFlight internal** (your team)	You plus 2–3 friends	Weeks 1–3
Closed (Google gate)	**Play closed testing**: 12+ testers × 14 days	15–20 recruits	**Weeks 2–5**
External beta	**TestFlight external** (needs a quick beta review; public link possible)	20–50 players	Weeks 4–6
Soft launch	Real store release in a few countries	Public	Weeks 7–8

Device matrix (minimum): one low-end Android (Android 10–12, 2–3 GB RAM), one recent Android and one iPhone. Use Firebase Test Lab's free quota for more Android devices **(⚠ check quota)**.

6.2 Soft launch

- **Markets: Canada, Australia, New Zealand**. They're English-speaking and comparable to the UK/US, and launching there keeps your main markets fresh. Optional extra: the **Philippines** for cheap volume and low-end device data.
- **How:** release to production with only those countries selected (Apple: Pricing and Availability; Google: Countries/regions). Run for **2 weeks**. Drive traffic with organic social posts, plus a small paid test if you can afford it (§9).
- **Note:** the Google Play production release needs the closed-test approval from §3.2 first.

6.3 Metrics and targets

Published benchmarks: GameAnalytics 2025 report on 2024 data, covering about 11,600 games (summary):

- D1 retention: top 25% of games **26.5–27.7%**, bottom 25% **10–11.5%**. On iOS the top 25% reach **31–33%**.
- D7 retention: median **3.4–3.9%**, top 25% **7–8%**.
- Session length: median **5–6 min**, top 25% **8–9 min**. Median daily playtime is 22 min.

- Arcade games lead on D1 but struggle with long-term retention.

Soft-launch targets for OrbiFlick. These are **rough rules of thumb, not sourced facts**:

Metric	"Fix before global"	"OK to launch"	"Great"
D1 retention	< 25%	30–35%	40%+
D7 retention	< 5%	8–10%	12%+
Avg session length	< 3 min	4–6 min	8 min+
Sessions per user per day	< 2	3–4	5+
Rewarded-revive opt-in (of runs where offered)	< 10%	20–35%	40%+
Crash-free users (Crashlytics)	< 99%	99.5%+	99.8%+
Ad ARPDAU (rewarded-only, Tier-1 countries)	—	**US$0.01–0.05 (estimate; varies a lot by country)**	—

If D1 is low: look at the first 60 seconds. Is the start speed too fast or too slow (it's currently 50%, +10% every 150 points)? Is the first death unfair? **If D7 is low:** strengthen the reasons to come back, such as the daily challenge, streak, skin goals and weekly events.

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7. Launch and marketing

7.1 Viral loops built into the game

☐ **Share-your-failure card:** on game over, draw a 1080×1920 image with the score, best combo, skin and a cheeky line ("Died at 312. Combo x7. Beat that."), then share it with `@capacitor/share` plus your store link.

☐ **Daily Challenge share, Wordle-style:** text such as `OrbiFlick Daily #42 ⭕ 318 pts 🔥x8` plus the link. It's the same course for everyone, so comparing scores is natural.

☐ **Challenge a friend:** share a "beat my score" link that opens the store. Later, add deep links that open the same daily seed.

☐ **Don't reward reviews or ratings with coins.** Both stores forbid incentivised reviews. Be cautious about rewarding shares too: Facebook/Meta bans incentivised sharing **(⚠ check each platform's rules)**.

7.2 Short-form video (TikTok, YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels)

- Post **3–5 clips a week from week 5**. Building a following before launch is the free part of user acquisition.
- Formats that suit OrbiFlick: an "Only 1% get past 500" challenge; near-miss compilations; speed-ramp "watch it get impossible"; skin reveals; honest "solo dev, day 30" diaries; reactions to friends failing.
- Keep each clip 7–15 s, with the hook in the first second, captions on and the store link in your bio. Reuse the same clip across all three platforms.

7.3 Communities

- **Reddit:** r/playmygame, r/IndieGaming, r/indiedev, r/iosgaming, r/AndroidGaming, r/hypercasual **(⚠ read each sub's self-promotion rules; many allow it only on set days)**. Post a GIF or clip plus a genuine "I made this solo" story, not an advert.

- **Discord:** start a small server for testers, and give early supporters a cosmetic "Founder" skin. A free cosmetic gift is fine.
- **Other:** itch.io (put the HTML5 version up free as a demo funnel), X/Bluesky #screenshotsaturday, local game-dev meetups.

7.4 Influencers and press

- Approach **micro-creators (5k–50k followers)** in mobile/casual gaming. Offer early access or promo codes, not big fees **(estimate: some will post for free; paid posts commonly cost tens to a few hundred pounds)**.
- Apple **offer codes** and Google Play **promo codes** let you give away premium skin packs.
- Make a one-page **press kit**: icon, 5 screenshots, GIF, 100-word description, links, contact.
- Submit a **featuring nomination** in App Store Connect about 3–6 weeks before launch, and apply to any Google Play indie programmes that are open **(⚠ check what's available)**.

7.5 Launch-day checklist

☐ Both versions approved and set to **manual release**, so you control the moment.

☐ Countries expanded from the soft-launch set to worldwide.

☐ Ads live: real ad unit IDs, `app-ads.txt` verified, test mode **off** (check the release build).

☐ IAP products **approved/active**; one real purchase tested and refunded.

☐ Leaderboards **published** (Google Play Games needs a separate publish step).

☐ Crashlytics and Analytics showing live data.

☐ Launch clip posted on TikTok, Shorts and Reels; Reddit and Discord posts ready.

☐ Press kit and emails sent to creators.

☐ Block out time to reply to reviews and fix bugs for the next 72 hours.

☐ Hotfix branch ready. Expedited review is available on Apple for critical bugs.

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8. Post-launch

8.1 Live ops (lightweight, for a solo creator)

- **Weekly:** a new or rotating skin in a "Featured" shop slot. Ship a **skin vault** in the app (e.g. 12 extra skins) and unlock them by date or with **Firebase Remote Config**. That way most weeks need no app update.
- **Events:** weekend double coins; a monthly "tournament" on a recurring leaderboard; seasonal themes (Christmas, Valentine's, Halloween) as palette and obstacle reskins.
- **Daily:** the challenge and streak you already have. Add a streak-saver as a rewarded ad (optional and capped).
- Change event text in Apple's **promotional text** with no review needed.

8.2 Updates

- **v1.0.x hotfixes** within 48 h for crashes.
- **Every 2–3 weeks** for the first 2 months: balance, new skins, player requests.
- **v1.1:** cloud save, friend challenges, more daily modes.
- Keep SDKs current. Both stores raise minimum SDK and API levels every year (Apple each spring, Google each August).

8.3 Reviews and ratings

☐ Ask for reviews with the native prompt (`@capacitor-community/in-app-review`) at a **happy moment**, such as a new personal best, never after a death. The OS limits how often the prompt appears.

☐ Reply to **every** review in the first month, in both consoles. Thank people and say what you fixed.

☐ Track rating, crash-free users, ANR rate (Android vitals) and retention weekly.

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9. Timeline and budget

9.1 Week-by-week (starting Monday 26 October 2026)

Week	Dates	Focus	Done when
1	26 Oct	**Secure orbiflick.com and @orbiflick; book trademark clearance** (do this now if you can). Enrol with Apple and Google. Set up Capacitor and Git. Remove the debug hook. Get it running on a phone.	App runs natively on Android (+ iOS via Mac/Codemagic)
2	2 Nov	Preferences storage + migration. Portrait lock, safe areas, back button, haptics, share. Icon and splash. **Start the Google closed test (12+ testers).** Draft the privacy policy and website.	Closed test live, 14-day clock running
3	9 Nov	AdMob rewarded + UMP + ATT (test IDs). RevenueCat + products in both stores. Restore button.	Test ad and sandbox purchase work on both platforms
4	16 Nov	Game Center + Play Games leaderboards. Firebase Analytics + Crashlytics. Low-effects mode. TestFlight external beta.	Scores post; events visible in Firebase
5	23 Nov	Store listings: screenshots, video, description, privacy labels, Data safety, ratings, target audience. Start posting short clips.	Listings complete in both consoles
6	30 Nov	Fix beta feedback. **Apply for Google production access** once 14 days are done. Submit iOS for review.	Production access granted; iOS approved
7	7 Dec	**Soft launch** (CA/AU/NZ) on both stores. Watch crashes daily.	Live in soft-launch markets
8	14 Dec	Read soft-launch metrics. Tune difficulty, revive placement and prices. Submit v1.0.1. Featuring nomination.	Go/no-go against §6.3 targets
—	21 Dec–3 Jan	**Holiday buffer.** Expect slower reviews and support at both stores **(⚠ check Apple's holiday notice)**. Light fixes and content prep only.	—
9	4 Jan 2027	Final polish. Line up creators, press kit and launch clips. Set manual release.	Launch checklist (§7.5) ✅
10	11 Jan 2027	**Global launch** (a Tuesday works well). Then 72 h of review replies and hotfixes.	Live worldwide

> **Fast track (about 7 weeks):** skip the separate soft launch and treat the first two live weeks as one. The Google 14-day test still sets the minimum pace.

9.2 Budget

Fixed fees are converted roughly at US$1 ≈ £0.75 **(estimate; Apple shows a local price at checkout)**. All other figures are **estimates**.

Item	Minimum	Comfortable	Notes
Apple Developer Program (year 1)	~£75 (US$99)	~£75	Verified fee; recurring yearly
Google Play Console	~£19 (US$25)	~£19	Verified; one-off
Domain + website (privacy, app-ads.txt, support)	£0–£12	£12	GitHub Pages is free
iOS builds	£0 (Codemagic free tier)	£400–£600 (used Mac mini)	
Test devices	£0 (own phone + friends)	£150–£300 (used iPhone + cheap Android)	
Icon / key art	£0 (DIY)	£50–£300 (freelancer)	
Privacy policy	£0 (generator + edit)	£0–£100	
RevenueCat, Firebase (Analytics/Crashlytics), AdMob, UMP	£0	£0	Free at this scale **(⚠ Firebase: stay on free plan unless you add Cloud Functions)**
ASO tool	£0	£0–£50 (one month)	
Soft-launch paid test	£0	£200–£500	Optional
Creators / promo	£0 (free codes)	£100–£500	
Music/SFX	£0 (current synth)	£0–£50	
Total (approx.)	**~£95–£110**	**~£1,000–£2,500**	

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10. Final pre-submission checklist

Code and build

☐ `window.ORBIFLICK` debug hook removed; `DEBUG=false`; no cheats or console commands

☐ Release build uses **real** AdMob IDs, and test IDs are gone. Check this twice.

☐ Version number and build number bumped (iOS `CFBundleVersion`, Android `versionCode`)

☐ Android: signed **AAB** with Play App Signing; **upload key backed up** somewhere safe; `targetSdk 36`

☐ iOS: built with **Xcode 26 / iOS 26 SDK**; minimum iOS set (Capacitor 8 default: 15)

☐ Portrait lock, safe areas and the Android back button all behave correctly

☐ Data survives app kill, phone restart and an app update (Preferences)

☐ Works in airplane mode (ads/leaderboards hidden or queued)

☐ 60 fps on a mid phone; playable on the low-end test phone

☐ Sound/haptics toggles work; silent switch, call interruption and backgrounding all tested

Monetisation

☐ Rewarded revive: opt-in, once per run, reward only on completion

☐ IAP: purchase, restore and reinstall tested on both stores; Restore button visible

☐ No pay-to-win; no random paid rewards

☐ `app-ads.txt` live on the developer website

Privacy and legal

☐ Privacy policy URL live and linked in both stores and in the app

☐ UMP consent shows for the UK/EEA (test with UMP debug geography); "Privacy settings" button reopens it

☐ ATT prompt and `NSUserTrackingUsageDescription` present (or you've deliberately decided not to track)

☐ Apple App Privacy labels + Google Data safety completed and matching your SDKs

☐ Apple age-rating questionnaire + Google IARC completed; Google target audience set

☐ Apple Paid Applications Agreement, tax and bank details done; Small Business Program enrolled; Google 15% tier enrolled where it applies

Store listing

☐ OrbiFlick cleared by a trademark lawyer (US, UK, EU; classes 9 and 41); orbiflick.com and @orbiflick registered

☐ Icon 1024 (Apple) + 512 (Google); feature graphic 1024×500

☐ Screenshots: Apple 1320×2868; Google phone set

☐ Preview video 15–30 s (Apple) / YouTube link (Google)

☐ Description, keywords, subtitle, short description, support URL, contact email

☐ App Review notes: "Single-player offline arcade game. No login required. Rewarded ads are optional. IAP can be tested with sandbox."

Google-specific

☐ Closed test: 12+ testers opted in for 14 continuous days; production access granted

☐ Play Games Services leaderboards **published**

Top decisions for you

1. **The name. OrbiFlick is chosen.** Register orbiflick.com and @orbiflick now, then get a trademark lawyer to clear it against the ORBI (class 9) marks before week 2. Decide whether to file your own trademark.
2. **What the paid "no ads" product is.** Your only ads are optional rewarded ones, so "remove ads" removes almost nothing. Choose between (a) **OrbiFlick Plus = free revives with no ad + an exclusive skin** (recommended), or (b) adding occasional interstitials and selling their removal. Option (b) goes against your "keep ads optional" principle.
3. **Audience and tracking.** Target 13+ and use UMP consent with ATT (more ad revenue, more paperwork), or keep it simpler with no ATT and non-personalised ads. Only include under-13s if you're ready to take on the Families Policy.

(Also: Mac or Codemagic for iOS builds, and whether to spend on a small soft-launch paid test.)

Sources

All accessed 21 October 2026.

- Apple Developer Program: enrol, US$99/year
- Apple: Membership details and commission
- App Store Small Business Program
- Apple: Upcoming requirements (Xcode 26 SDK since 28 Apr 2026)
- Apple: Set an app age rating · Age rating updates
- Apple: App Review Guidelines (4.2 Minimum Functionality; 3.1.1 IAP / loot-box odds)
- Apple screenshot specifications
- Apple app preview specifications
- Apple: App privacy details · App Tracking Transparency
- Play Console: get started, US$25 fee
- Play Console: testing requirements for new personal accounts
- Google Play service fees · 15% tier enrolment
- Google blog: Expanded billing choice and lower fees, 24 Jun 2026
- Google Play target API level requirements
- Google Play Families policies · Target audience settings
- Google Play Data safety
- AdMob: consent requirements for EEA, UK, Switzerland · Rewarded ad policies
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- AdMob Play Data safety disclosure
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- RevenueCat billing · Pricing
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- GameAnalytics 2025 benchmarks summary · Report
- Name screening for OrbiFlick (22 Oct 2026): searches of the App Store, Google Play, the USPTO trademark register, domain availability and social handles. Results in §5.1.